

Nausea - Female (Adult)

Algorithm 1222 | Adult (18 years and older) | Gender at birth: Female

Definition

- Nausea assessment decomposed from NHS.UK's published diarrhoea and vomiting guidance.
- Adult patient.
- Female.

Initial assessment

1. [OPEN_TEXT] What is the person's exact age and sex, are they pregnant/recently postpartum, and when did nausea start? Ask about vomiting, pain, chest/neurological symptoms, hydration/urine, diabetes/ketones, medicines/substances, poisoning, infection, and child safeguarding.
2. [YES_NO] Any vomiting?
3. [YES_NO] Able to keep fluids down?

Triage and redirect questions

1. Redirect → Diarrhea

Are frequent loose or watery stools the main concern rather than nausea itself?

A presentation dominated by loose or watery stools belongs in the Diarrhea pathway.

1. Disposition level 100

Is there vomit that looks like blood or ground coffee, green vomit, a stiff neck with light sensitivity, a sudden severe headache or tummy ache, blue/grey/pale skin, severe breathing difficulty, or confusion?

NHS.UK diarrhoea and vomiting guidance lists these as Qatar 999/an emergency assessment service selected through the Qatar pathway approved by governance (GOVERNANCE_REQUIRED) criteria.

1. Disposition level 70

Is the person unable to keep fluids down, or has vomiting lasted more than 2 days?

NHS.UK guidance recommends contacting the Qatar clinical-review pathway approved by governance (GOVERNANCE_REQUIRED) for these features.

1. Disposition level 15

Is this mild nausea with none of the features above?

NHS.UK guidance: rest and small sips of fluid usually help mild nausea, which typically settles within a day or two.

Advice

Qatar emergency nausea-associated response

- Call Qatar emergency services on 999 and do not drive for chest pain, severe abdominal/head pain, abnormal breathing, confusion, fainting, seizure, stroke signs, blood/coffee-ground or green vomit, major bleeding, poisoning, pregnancy emergency features, or severe dehydration. Do not give food, drink, or oral medicine if drowsy, repeatedly vomiting, or unsafe to swallow. Call Qatar 999 now, follow the call-taker's ambulance and emergency-transport instructions, and do not self-drive. Do not delay emergency care.
- Call Back If: confusion, collapse, seizure, or breathing difficulty; blood/green vomit or severe pain; very little urine, marked weakness, or inability to keep fluids down.

Urgent nausea review

- Arrange same-day medical review, especially if fluids cannot be kept down.
- Call Back If: signs of dehydration worsen.

Home care for mild nausea

- Rest, sip fluids slowly, avoid fatty or spicy food, and eat small, plain meals when able.
- Call Back If: vomiting develops; unable to keep fluids down.

First aid

- Call Qatar emergency services on 999 and do not drive for chest pain, severe abdominal/head pain, abnormal breathing, confusion, fainting, seizure, stroke signs, blood/coffee-ground or green vomit, major bleeding, poisoning, pregnancy emergency features, or severe dehydration. Do not give food, drink, or oral medicine if drowsy, repeatedly vomiting, or unsafe to swallow. Call Qatar 999 now, follow the call-taker's ambulance and emergency-transport instructions, and do not self-drive. Do not delay emergency care.

References

- NHS.UK, "Diarrhoea and vomiting", <https://www.nhs.uk/conditions/diarrhoea/> (page last reviewed 21 December 2023)

Provenance

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